

SUHRAWARDY AS PM OF PAKISTAN

(1956 TO 1957)

AWAMI LEAGUE FORMED COALITION GOVT

- IN 1956, THE AWAMI LEAGUE FORMED A COALITION WITH PAKISTAN'S REPUBLICAN PARTY TO UNSEAT THE PREVIOUS GOVERNMENT. SUHRAWARDY BECAME THE FIFTH PRIME MINISTER OF PAKISTAN AND THE SECOND PREMIER UNDER THE 1956 CONSTITUTION OF PAKISTAN.
- SUHRAWARDY WAS KNOWN AS A PRO-AMERICAN POLITICIAN. HE ALSO CULTIVATED PRAGMATIC TIES WITH COMMUNIST CHINA. SUHRAWARDY SUPPORTED THE AMERICAN-LED SOUTHEAST ASIA TREATY ORGANIZATION (SEATO) AND THE CENTRAL TREATY ORGANIZATION (CENTO).
- IN DOMESTIC POLICY, SUHRAWARDY ADDRESSED ISSUES OF NUCLEAR ENERGY, FOREIGN AID UTILIZATION, FOOD POLICY, THE ONE UNIT FRAMEWORK, AND BUILDING UP THE MILITARY. HIS STAUNCHLY PRO-WESTERN FOREIGN POLICY WAS OPPOSED BY BENGALI RADICALS LED BY MAULANA BHASHANI WHO CAUSED A SPLIT IN THE AWAMI LEAGUE. HOWEVER, SUHRAWARDY WAS ELECTED AS PRESIDENT OF THE AWAMI LEAGUE. HIS CABINET INCLUDED FEROZE KHAN NOON, ABUL MANSUR AHMED. HIS TENURE AS PRIME MINISTER WAS FROM 12 SEPT 1956 TO 17 OCT 1957.

ONE UNIT

- THE ONE UNIT SCHEME WAS THE REORGANISATION OF THE PROVINCES OF PAKISTAN BY THE CENTRAL PAKISTANI GOVERNMENT. IT WAS LED BY PRIME MINISTER MUHAMMAD ALI BOGRA ON 22 NOVEMBER 1954 AND ENACTED ON 30 SEPTEMBER 1955.
- THE GOVERNMENT CLAIMED THAT THE PROGRAMME WOULD OVERCOME THE DIFFICULTY OF ADMINISTERING THE TWO NON-CONTIGUOUS, UNEQUAL POLITIES OF WEST AND EAST PAKISTAN SEPARATED FROM EACH OTHER BY MORE THAN A THOUSAND MILES. THE CONCEPT OF PARITY WAS ASSOCIATED WITH THIS PROGRAMME.
- TO DIMINISH THE DIFFERENCES BETWEEN THE TWO REGIONS, THE 'ONE UNIT' PROGRAMME MERGED THE FOUR PROVINCES OF WEST PAKISTAN (WEST PUNJAB, SIND, THE NORTH-WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE (NWFP) AND BALUCHISTAN) INTO A SINGLE PROVINCE TO PARALLEL THE PROVINCE OF EAST PAKISTAN (NOW BANGLADESH).

PROVINCIAL GOVT

- FROM 1955 TO 1958 PRIOR TO THE IMPOSITION OF MARTIAL LAW IN 1958 THERE HAD BEEN FREQUENT CHANGE OF CHIEF MINISTER IN EAST PAKISTAN.
- ABUL HOSSAIN SARKAR OF KRISHAK SRAMIK PARTY AND ATAUR RAHMAN OF AWAMI LEAGUE SUCCEEDED EACH OTHER DURING THIS PERIOD. AN UNSTABLE SITUATION WAS PREVAILING AND THE SITUATION ULTIMATELY ENDED WITH IMPOSITION OF MARTIAL LAW.

FIRST MARTIAL LAW IN PAKISTAN

- THE FIRST INSTANCE OF MARTIAL LAW IN PAKISTAN WAS DECLARED ON OCTOBER 7, 1958, BY PRESIDENT ISKANDER MIRZA. HE ABROGATED THE CONSTITUTION, IMPOSED MARTIAL LAW, AND APPOINTED GENERAL MUHAMMAD AYUB KHAN AS CHIEF MARTIAL LAW ADMINISTRATOR. HOWEVER, AYUB KHAN SUBSEQUENTLY REMOVED MIRZA FROM POWER AND ASSUMED THE PRESIDENCY HIMSELF.
- FORMALIZATION OF MILITARIZATION: AYUB KHAN'S ACTIONS EFFECTIVELY FORMALIZED THE MILITARIZATION OF PAKISTAN'S POLITICAL SYSTEM.
- CONSTITUTIONAL CHANGES: THE 1956 CONSTITUTION WAS ABROGATED, AND A NEW CONSTITUTION, THE CONSTITUTION OF 1962, WAS ADOPTED LATER.

BASIC DEMOCRACY

- **BASIC DEMOCRACY** WAS A GOVERNANCE SYSTEM IMPLEMENTED BY AYUB KHAN GOVERNMENT IN PAKISTAN IN 1959 WHEN THE BASIC DEMOCRACIES ORDER WAS PROMULGATED.
- ORGANIZED INTO FIVE HIERARCHICAL TIERS, THE SYSTEM COMMENCED WITH UNION COUNCILS IN RURAL AREAS AND TOWN COMMITTEES IN URBAN AREAS, FOLLOWED BY THANA COUNCILS IN EAST PAKISTAN AND TEHSIL COUNCILS IN WEST PAKISTAN, THEN DISTRICT COUNCILS, DIVISIONAL COUNCILS, AND CONCLUDED WITH PROVINCIAL DEVELOPMENT ADVISORY COUNCILS.
- MEMBERS OF THIS COUNCIL FORMED ELECTORAL COLLEGE TO ELECT PRESIDENT, CENTRAL AND PROVINCIAL LEGISLATURE. THE CONCEPT OF BASIC DEMOCRACY WAS BASED ON STRONG CENTRALIZED GOVT AND ALL POWERFUL PRESIDENCY. AYUB INCORPORATED BASIC DEMOCRACY SYSTEM IN 1962 CONSTITUTION.

EDUCATION MOVEMENT

SHARIF COMMISSION: PRESIDENT OF PAKISTAN AYUB KHAN DECLARED TO FORM A COMMISSION TO ESTABLISH AN EDUCATION POLICY ON 30 DECEMBER 1958 AND IT WAS FORMED ON 5 JANUARY 1959. THE CHAIRMAN OF THIS COMMISSION WAS THE SECRETARY OF THE EDUCATION DEPARTMENT OF WEST PAKISTAN NAMED S. M. SHARIF. TOTAL NUMBER OF MEMBER OF THAT COMMISSION WAS ELEVEN WITH ONLY FOUR MEMBERS FROM EAST PAKISTAN. THIS COMMISSION WAS CALLED THE COMMISSION ON NATIONAL EDUCATION AND POPULARLY KNOWN AS "SHARIF COMMISSION".

EDUCATION MOVEMENT

RECOMMENDATIONS OF THE REPORT

ON 26 AUGUST 1959, THE COMMISSION SUBMITTED THEIR REPORT WHICH WAS PUBLISHED AS A BOOK ON 1962.

- THEY DECLARED EDUCATION AS A PRODUCT. THIS REPORT SAYS: "WE HAVE TO CHANGE THE TRADITIONAL THINKING OF THE PEOPLES ABOUT EDUCATION. THEY THINK THAT EDUCATION IS A CHEAP THING WHICH SHOULD BE CHANGED. WE HAVE TO REMEMBER THE TRUTH THAT HIGH QUALITY PRODUCTS HAVE HIGH PRICE."
- THEY DIVIDED THE TOTAL EDUCATION SYSTEM IN THREE PARTS, SUCH AS PRIMARY LEVEL, SECONDARY LEVEL AND HIGHER LEVEL. THE DURATION OF PRIMARY AND HIGHER LEVEL COURSE WAS 5 YEARS AND HIGHER DEGREE COURSE HAS DURATION OF 3 YEARS. THE DURATION OF POST GRADUATION COURSE WAS 2 YEARS
- MARKS REQUIRED TO PASS EXAM WAS 50, SECOND CLASS MARK WAS 60 AND FIRST CLASS MARK WAS 70. THEY HAD RECOMMENDATIONS TO BAN STUDENT POLITICS, TO OBSERVE THE ACTIVITIES OF TEACHERS AND THE DURATION OF THE WORK OF TEACHERS SHOULD BE 15 HOURS. THEY WANTED TO APPLY ROMAN ALPHABETS IN PLACE OF BANGLA ALPHABET.
- URDU TO BE THE LANGUAGE OF PAKISTAN.
- ENGLISH SHOULD BE COMPULSORY FROM GRADE SIX.

EDUCATION MOVEMENT

- THE STUDENT OF EAST PAKISTAN INCLUDING CHATRA UNION AND CHATRA LEAGUE STARTED STRONG MOVEMENT AND CALLED HARTAL ON SEPT 17 AGAINST THIS ANTI PEOPLE EDUCATION REPORT. POLICE OPENED FIRE ON THE AGITATING STUDENT RESULTING IN THE DEATH OF BABUL, GULAM MOSTAFA AND WAZIULLAH IN THE HIGH COURT PREMISES. A LABOURER, SUNDAR ALI WAS ALSO KILLED IN TONGI.
- IN THE FACE OF AGITATION PAKISTAN GOVT POSTPONED THE REPORT OF THE COMMISSION. SINCE THEN 17 SEPT IS OBSERVED AS EDUCATION DAY IN BANGLADESH

DEATH OF FAZLUL HUQ AND SUHRAWARDY

- FAZLUL HUQ DIED IN DHAKA, EAST PAKISTAN (NOW DHAKA, BANGLADESH) ON 27 APRIL 1962. HE IS BURIED IN THE MAUSOLEUM OF THREE LEADERS, SHER-E-BANGLA NAGAR, WHERE THE NATIONAL PARLIAMENT IS LOCATED, IS NAMED IN HIS HONOUR.
- SUHRAWARDY DIED IN BEIRUT, LEBANON IN 1963 DUE TO A HEART ATTACK. MANY BENGALIS WERE - AND SOME STILL ARE - CONVINCED THAT HE WAS KILLED ON AYUB KHAN'S ORDER, AS HIS POPULARITY MAY HAVE MADE HIM A POWERFUL RIVAL TO AYUB IN THE UPCOMING PRESIDENTIAL ELECTIONS. HE WAS BURIED IN DHAKA BESIDE SIR KHAWAJA NAZIMUDDIN AND A. K. FAZLUL HUQ, SIGNIFYING HIS TOWERING STATURE IN BENGALI POLITICS AS ONE OF THE THREE LEADING BENGALI STATESMEN OF THE EARLY 20TH CENTURY.

ELECTION 1965 AND INDIA PAKISTAN WAR OF 1965

- THE PRESIDENTIAL ELECTION OF 1965 GAVE A CHANCE TO AYUB KHAN'S OPPONENT TO CHALLENGE HIS BASIC DEMOCRACIES AND AUTHORITARIAN RULE. BUT THEIR BUILT IN AUTHORITARIAN SYSTEM ENSURED THE DEFEAT OF FATIMA JINNAH, SISTER OF MOHAMMED ALI JINNAH, FOUNDING FATHER OF PAKISTAN.
- THE ELECTION WAS FOLLOWED BY INDIA-PAKISTAN WAR IN 1965 WHICH SHOOK THE AYUB KHANS POWER AND AUTHORITY. EAST PAKISTAN WAS QUITE DEFENCELESS AT THAT TIME. THE WAR WAS ENDED THROUGH TASHKENT AGREEMENT BROKERED BY USSR.